

It was never the bite. It has only ever been the dying.

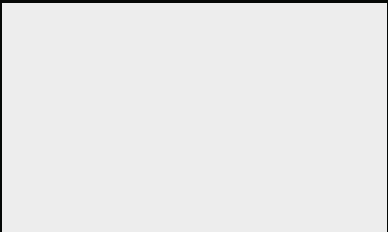
There were eleven days between the first alarming Tuesday and the night the electricity stopped. The country did not panic. Quietly, individually, deniably, it got a few tins in.

Neil Cowie was an assistant category manager. He did crisps. He was on floor six arguing about eleven centimetres of shelf when the phones started going, and what he remembers about the walk home is that it was a beautiful day, and that some part of him was relieved.

What follows is a farm above a beck, a laminated sheet of rules on a parlour door, twenty-one tablets, and a decision made round a kitchen table in November that turns out, fourteen months later, to have been based on something nobody had bothered to tell anybody.

FICTION · 6/WEL/04

HILLFOOT PRESS



A NOVEL

THE HANDOVER

THE HANDOVER

MURTAZA RAZA

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